

Publication Policy

1. Purpose

The policy outlines how Swaniti employees and consultants should approach publications under their name. The intent of creating this policy is to ensure that all publications are in alignment with the organizations programs.

2. Scope

This policy is enforceable to all the employees and consultants of Swaniti Initiative.

3. Policy

The 'Publication Policy' is enforced in the organisation in line with the Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) which is agreed and signed by everyone associated with the organisation. The exercise of publishing any knowledge product needs to be taken seriously as there remains a conflict of interest on the insights generated. The team members are expected to take following points into consideration when pursuing any publication other than the Swaniti platform. This includes the following:

- i. The knowledge and insights generated at work are solely the intellectual property of the organisation and the writer will have no copyrights over it
- ii. The insight papers developed by the team members for the purpose of publishing should not have any trace of utilization of data sets developed by the organization (other than those approved for work purposes by the reporting manager).
- iii. In the case of intellectual property rights regarding data and insights, if the organisation and the employee both claim to the first receiver of the data, the intellectual property rights of the organisation will supersede
- iv. The employee, if wishes to publish a knowledge piece, on a platform other than that in Swaniti, must get the piece (or the abstract) vetted by the reporting manager through email.
- v. The clearance for publication will be a two-tier process where the final call will be taken by the Talent Management Team
- vi. The employee must ensure that a request for the No Objection Certificate, email confirmation and/or any other **written** form of confirmation is placed with the Talent Manager or the equivalent before taking the piece out

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- vii. In case of retrospective revelation of utilization of organization's data or insights may attract review of the engagement as per the clause of confidentiality and code of conduct

4. Process of getting No-objection Certificate

The process for getting the NOC is as following:

- Place a written request via email with the reporting manager attaching the synopsis and the vital data points of the piece or paper which will go out for publication
- Put signature on the undertaking (format attached in Annexure 1) and share the signed copy of the undertaking with the reporting manager
- Once approved by the reporting manager, the Talent Management Team will issue the NOC on request from the writer
- Please note: the only exception to this is when joint pieces for publications are developed for Swaniti programs. These processes are initiated by reporting manager and developed collaboratively.

5. In case of publication without NOC

- i. The publication without NOC will be in contravention with the non-disclosure agreement and thus the case will be treated as per the recommendation of the reflecting clauses of Schedule C of the employment/consultancy agreement
- ii. The publication on a platform which itself may be or may be created by a competent of the organisation will be treated as per the recommendation of the reflecting clauses of Schedule C of the employment/consultancy agreement
- iii. Any publication which is not categorized, if published without obtaining an NOC by the sole writer, will be attracting review of confidentiality and intellectual property clauses.
- iv. This should be noted that breach of confidentiality and violation of intellectual property right qualifies to be taken as 'gross misconduct' or 'gross negligence' and will be attracting review of the employment as mentioned in the offer letter.

6. Grievance redressal

- All grievance regarding the assessment of requests for NOC will be dealt by the senior management of the organisation and for which Talent Management team will remain the point of contact.

Acknowledgement

Yes, I have read the publication policy along with the consultancy/employment agreement of Swaniti Initiative. I understand and accept the obligations, which it imposes upon me without reservation.

Employee Name:

Date:

Signature:

Annexure -1

Dear (Reporting Manager name),

I, [Full name], declare that the proposed piece of knowledge is completely an independent work and it does not use the information or data or insight developed exclusively by the organisation.

I also declare that the publication of my piece with [name of the platform] will be done after full satisfaction of the publication policy of the organisation.

I hereby declare that the vital data points are communicated to the reporting manager, and it was not found in contravention with the NDA, IPR and clauses of publication policy of the organisation.

I declare this on _____ (day) of _____ (month) of _____ (year)

Signature:

Name of the employee:

Employee Number:

Date:

Accepted and verified by

Signature:

Name of the employee:

Date: